

NexaCore Technologies Pvt. Ltd.

HUMAN RESOURCES POLICY MANUAL

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Bengaluru · Mumbai · Hyderabad · Chennai

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SECTION 1

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This manual supersedes all prior HR policy documents. All employees are required to read, understand, and comply with the policies stated herein. For queries, contact hr@nexacore.in.

SECTION 2

Company Overview & HR Philosophy

About NexaCore Technologies

NexaCore Technologies Pvt. Ltd. is a leading technology solutions company headquartered in Bengaluru, India, with offices across Mumbai, Hyderabad, and Chennai. Founded in 2010, we specialize in enterprise software, cloud infrastructure, AI/ML platforms, and managed IT services. With a workforce of over 3,200 professionals, NexaCore serves Fortune 500 clients across Asia-Pacific, Europe, and North America.

Our Mission

To build transformative technology products that create lasting value for our clients, employees, and communities — powered by innovation, integrity, and inclusion.

HR Philosophy

NexaCore's Human Resources function is rooted in the belief that people are our greatest competitive advantage. Our HR policies are designed to:

- Foster a culture of fairness, respect, and psychological safety
- Enable professional growth through continuous learning and mentorship
- Ensure competitive compensation aligned with industry benchmarks
- Maintain transparency in all people-related processes
- Champion diversity, equity, and inclusion across all levels

Core HR Values

Integrity	We uphold honesty and ethical behavior in every interaction.
Inclusion	We celebrate diverse perspectives and ensure equitable opportunities.
Innovation	We encourage creative thinking and calculated risk-taking.
Accountability	We take ownership of our work and its outcomes.
Collaboration	We achieve more together than individually.

SECTION 3

Employment Classification & Probation

3.1 Employment Categories

NexaCore classifies its workforce into the following categories. Benefits, leave entitlements, and applicable policies may vary by category.

Full-Time Permanent	Regular employees on indefinite contracts working 40 hrs/week.	Full
Part-Time Permanent	Regular employees working less than 30 hrs/week on fixed schedules.	Partial
Fixed-Term Contract	Employees hired for a specific project or defined duration.	Limited
Intern / Trainee	Students or fresh graduates in a structured learning program (3-12 months).	Basic
Consultant / Freelancer	Independent professionals engaged on project-based agreements.	None

3.2 Probation Period

All new full-time and part-time permanent employees are subject to a probation period of **six (6) months** from the date of joining. During probation:

- Performance is reviewed at the end of Month 3 and Month 6
- The company or the employee may terminate employment with 2 weeks' notice
- Employees are entitled to statutory benefits but are not eligible for leave encashment
- Confirmation of employment is based on satisfactory performance review

Note: The probation period may be extended by up to 3 months at the discretion of the reporting manager and HR, with written notice to the employee.

3.3 Background Verification

All employment offers are conditional upon successful completion of a pre-employment background verification process, which includes:

- Identity and address verification
- Academic credentials and professional certification checks
- Previous employment history verification (last 7 years)
- Criminal record check as per applicable law

Any discrepancy found during verification may result in withdrawal of the offer or termination of employment, regardless of the stage at which it is discovered.

SECTION 4

Working Hours, Attendance & Leave Policy

4.1 Standard Working Hours

NexaCore follows a 5-day work week (Monday to Friday). Standard working hours are **9:00 AM to 6:00 PM IST**, inclusive of a 1-hour lunch break, totalling **8 productive hours** per day. Employees in shift-based or client-aligned roles may have different schedules as defined in their offer letter.

4.2 Flexible Work Arrangements

NexaCore offers flexible work options subject to role requirements and manager approval:

- Flexi-time: Core hours 10:00 AM–4:00 PM; start and end times flexible
- Work From Home (WFH): Up to 2 days per week for eligible roles
- Remote-first roles: Fully remote, as specified in the employment contract
- Compressed work week: Available for senior employees with CHRO approval

4.3 Leave Entitlements

Earned Leave (EL)	18	Up to 15	Encashable at year-end
Casual Leave (CL)	8	None	Cannot be clubbed with EL
Sick Leave (SL)	10	Up to 5	Medical certificate >3 days
Maternity Leave	182	N/A	As per Maternity Benefit Act
Paternity Leave	10	None	Within 6 months of birth
Bereavement Leave	5	None	Immediate family only
Marriage Leave	3	None	Once in service tenure
Public / National Holidays	14	N/A	As per state holiday list
Compensatory Off	Per policy	6 months	For approved overtime work

Leave must be applied through the HRMS portal at least 3 working days in advance for planned leaves. Unapproved absences beyond 3 consecutive days may be treated as Loss of Pay (LOP).

SECTION 5

Compensation, Payroll & Benefits

5.1 Compensation Philosophy

NexaCore benchmarks compensation against the top quartile of the Indian IT industry using reputable surveys (Mercer, Aon, Willis Towers Watson). Our total rewards package comprises fixed pay, variable pay, and long-term incentives where applicable.

5.2 Salary Structure

Basic Salary	40%	Taxable; basis for PF, gratuity computation
House Rent Allowance (HRA)	20%	50% of basic for metro, 40% for non-metro
Special Allowance	20%	Fully taxable; paid monthly
Variable Pay / Bonus	10%	Based on individual + company performance
Provident Fund (PF)	12%	Employer contribution; statutory
Gratuity Provision	4.8%	Statutory; payable after 5 years of service
Medical Insurance Premium	3.2%	Covers employee + 3 dependants
Other Benefits	Varies	NPS, meal card, transport, LTA, etc.

5.3 Payroll Processing

- Salaries are credited on the **last working day** of each month
- Payslips are available via the HRMS portal by the 2nd of the following month
- Income Tax is deducted at source (TDS) as per the declared tax regime
- Form 16 is issued by May 31 each financial year

5.4 Employee Benefits

- Group Medical Insurance: INR 5,00,000 per annum (employee + spouse + 2 children + parents)
- Group Term Life Insurance: 3x annual CTC
- Personal Accident Insurance: 5x annual CTC
- Employee Stock Option Plan (ESOP): For Band 4 and above, subject to vesting schedule
- NexaCore Wellness Program: Annual health check-up, gym reimbursement up to INR 6,000/year
- Meal Card: INR 2,200/month loaded on prepaid card (tax-exempt under Section 17)

SECTION 6

Code of Conduct & Workplace Ethics

6.1 General Standards of Conduct

All NexaCore employees are expected to conduct themselves with professionalism, respect, and integrity at all times — whether in the office, at client sites, during travel, or in any virtual/online interaction representing the company.

- Treat all colleagues, clients, and vendors with dignity and respect
- Maintain confidentiality of sensitive company and client information
- Avoid conflicts of interest; disclose potential conflicts to HR immediately
- Refrain from accepting gifts exceeding INR 1,500 in value from vendors or clients
- Dress code: Business casual in office; formal for client meetings

6.2 Prevention of Sexual Harassment (POSH)

NexaCore is committed to providing a safe and harassment-free workplace in compliance with the Sexual Harassment of Women at Workplace (Prevention, Prohibition and Redressal) Act, 2013. The company has constituted an Internal Complaints Committee (ICC) at each location.

- Any employee experiencing or witnessing harassment may report to the ICC
- Complaints will be investigated within 60 days of receipt
- Strict confidentiality is maintained throughout the process
- Retaliation against complainants is strictly prohibited and is a serious misconduct

ICC Contact: icc@nexacore.in | Toll-Free: 1800-XXX-XXXX

6.3 Anti-Bribery & Anti-Corruption

NexaCore has a zero-tolerance policy towards bribery and corruption. Employees must not offer, give, request, or accept any bribe or improper payment in any form. Violations will result in immediate termination and may be reported to law enforcement authorities.

6.4 Social Media Policy

Employees may use personal social media but must not:

- Share confidential, proprietary, or client information on any platform
- Represent personal opinions as official NexaCore statements
- Post content that is defamatory, discriminatory, or disparaging toward colleagues or clients
- Use the NexaCore logo or brand assets without prior written approval from Marketing

SECTION 7

Performance Management

7.1 Performance Review Cycle

NexaCore follows a continuous performance management approach anchored in OKRs (Objectives and Key Results). The annual cycle consists of:

Goal Setting	April (Q1)	Employee and manager align OKRs for the year
Mid-Year Review	October (Q2)	Progress check; goals may be re-calibrated
Annual Appraisal	Jan-Feb	360-degree feedback, rating, increment discussion
Increment Effective	April 1	Salary revision letters issued; ESOP vesting review

7.2 Performance Rating Scale

5	Exceptional	Consistently exceeds all expectations; role model	15-25%
4	Exceeds Expectations	Frequently surpasses goals; high-impact contributor	10-15%
3	Meets Expectations	Delivers on all goals; solid and reliable performer	6-10%
2	Needs Improvement	Partially meets goals; a PIP (Performance Improvement Plan) may be initiated	0-5%
1	Unsatisfactory	Consistently fails to meet expectations; disciplinary action possible	0%

A forced distribution is not applied. Managers are expected to differentiate performance objectively based on documented evidence and outcomes.

SECTION 8

Training, Development & Career Growth

8.1 Learning & Development Philosophy

NexaCore invests a minimum of **5% of payroll** annually in Learning & Development (L&D;). We believe that skill development is a shared responsibility between the employee and the organisation. Our 70-20-10 development model guides all learning interventions:

- 70% — On-the-job learning through challenging assignments and stretch projects
- 20% — Social learning via mentoring, peer coaching, and cross-functional collaboration
- 10% — Formal training through courses, certifications, and workshops

8.2 Training Programs

- **Induction Program:** 2-week onboarding for all new joiners covering company culture, tools, and processes
- **Functional Training:** Role-specific technical and domain training through internal academies
- **Leadership Development:** NexaCore Leadership Ladder program for Band 4+ employees
- **External Certifications:** Company-sponsored certifications (AWS, GCP, PMP, CFA, etc.) with a 12-month service bond
- **Online Learning:** Unlimited access to LinkedIn Learning, Pluralsight, and Coursera for all employees

8.3 Individual Development Plan (IDP)

Every employee is required to create and maintain an Individual Development Plan in the HRMS portal. IDPs are reviewed quarterly with the reporting manager and form part of the annual performance appraisal input.

8.4 Internal Job Postings (IJP)

NexaCore encourages internal mobility. Employees who have completed a minimum of **18 months** in their current role may apply for Internal Job Postings. IJPs are advertised on the intranet every Monday. The selection process is the same as external hiring. Managers are not permitted to withhold an employee's IJP application without documented justification.

8.5 Certification Reimbursement Policy

Band 1-2 (Junior)	INR 20,000	6 months
Band 3 (Mid-Level)	INR 40,000	12 months
Band 4-5 (Senior)	INR 75,000	18 months
Band 6+ (Leadership)	INR 1,50,000	24 months

SECTION 9

Grievance Redressal & Disciplinary Policy

9.1 Grievance Redressal Process

NexaCore provides a structured, confidential, and fair grievance mechanism. Employees may raise grievances related to working conditions, interpersonal issues, policy interpretation, or any other work-related concern.

Step 1	Discuss with reporting manager informally	Within 5 working days
Step 2	Submit written grievance on HRMS portal to HRBP	Within 10 working days
Step 3	HRBP conducts investigation and issues resolution	Within 15 working days
Step 4	Appeal to HR Head if employee is not satisfied	Within 7 working days
Step 5	Final escalation to CHRO / Employee Relations Committee	Within 10 working days

9.2 Disciplinary Actions

Disciplinary action is taken in a progressive manner:

- **Verbal Warning:** For minor first-time misconduct
- **Written Warning:** For repeated or moderate misconduct
- **Final Written Warning:** For serious misconduct with performance impact
- **Suspension:** Unpaid suspension pending investigation (up to 30 days)
- **Termination for Cause:** Gross misconduct, fraud, harassment, data theft

SECTION 10

Data Privacy, IT Use & Policy Amendments

10.1 Data Privacy

NexaCore complies with the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 (DPDPA) and applicable data protection laws. Employee personal data is collected solely for employment purposes and will not be shared with third parties without consent, except as required by law.

10.2 Acceptable IT Use

- Company devices and network must be used primarily for business purposes
- Installation of unauthorized software is prohibited
- All company data must be stored in approved cloud platforms only (Google Workspace, SharePoint)
- Employees must not use personal email to send company data

10.3 Policy Amendments

NexaCore reserves the right to amend, modify, or withdraw any policy at any time. Employees will be notified of significant changes via email and HRMS announcements with a minimum of **15 days' notice**. The latest version of all policies is always available on the HR intranet portal.

EMPLOYEE ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I have read, understood, and agree to comply with all policies stated in this HR Policy Manual. I acknowledge that non-compliance may result in disciplinary action.

Employee Name: _____ Employee ID: _____

Signature: _____ Date: _____